with the Research and Referral Hospital at Delhi. The cases were taken up with the ministry of defence and hopefully, we shall see them materialize in due course. At the field level, the endeavour was to induct the latest life-saving equipment so that the 'golden hour' principle could be meaningfully implemented. As a result, the fatalities during evacuation have been brought down considerably.

Overall, we were able to carry out a fair amount of modernization and enhancement of our capability in terms of night-fighting equipment, sensors, battlefield surveillance radars and equipment for net-centric and information warfare as also in the domain of logistics. If some more of our proposals had fructified in a shorter time frame, I would have been even more satisfied. It was sad to see some of our major acquisition projects running into heavy weather in the last stages, for reasons which are best known to the government.

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[1] Gurmeet Kanwal, *Army Vision 2020*, p. 200. Excerpts of an interview given by me to SP's Guide Publications, *The Chiefs Spoke*, SP's ShowNews (Defence Expo daily), 31 January 2006.